If an action's policy is purely relational, you can skip the PDP check. For example, if a policy has no dynamic context or PIP lookups, the relationship graph alone is authoritative. C³ designates such actions as listable and responds directly from the index without consulting the PDP. But if a policy incorporates time, risk, or other contextual checks, the PDP must be used to verify the decision.

Performance and UX tips

These listing queries may involve thousands of entities, so performance and usability are just as important as correctness. C³ keeps them fast by using batching, caching, and consistent interfaces across layers:

- Execute multiple evaluations as a batch to reduce network overhead between the UI service and the PDP.
- Page large result sets and cache short-lived `permit` outcomes keyed by fields like `tenant_id`, principal, action, resource, or a scope hash.
- Maintain both forward (principal → resources) and reverse (resource → principals) indexes for efficient graph traversal.
- For administrative questions like "Who can access this document?", perform the check using a dedicated auditor context. This context reflects current runtime conditions—such as time, tenant, and policy inputs—so the results reflect who would be permitted right now, not just who appears in the relationship graph.
- Keep the UI and backend aligned: the same decision API that hides unavailable buttons in the interface also manages access in the service layer.

Together, these practices ensure that search-driven features remain responsive while ensuring that UI results accurately reflect live policy decisions. Users see only what they can actually open or share if they click through, and ACME avoids keeping a separate, outdated view of access visibility.